3

Service Procedures

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Learning Objectives

- Know the requirement of a cover
- Acquire skill in cover laying
- Gain knowledge in different styles and types of food services
- Understand the importance of implementing effective service procedures

Serving food is an art which can make or break the reputation of a catering establishment. Serving food is a complete and wholesome dining experience for the customer and this is important to get repeat customers. A wholesome dining experience represents the manner, ambience and the way in which food is served to the customer. Even well prepared, good quality dishes can be rejected if the service is poor and the waiter is unkept in appearance, impolite and careless.



Plate 3.1 Service in a Restaurant

Creating a pleasant atmosphere, delivering enjoyable food, responding to feedback and treating customers more than their expectations should be the motto of all food service establishments to maintain quality.

The first impression a guest has, is at the dining table and hence it is important that the table is set neatly and efficiently. Table laying in a food service is termed as cover laying and one of the technical terms used is a **cover.**

3.1 Definition of Cover and Table Setting Requirements

A "cover" is a table setting for a person to dine in a restaurant. If the table can accommodate four persons/guests, then it could be "four covers" or if for two then "two covers".

The term is marked as cover since a cloth is used to cover the items and protect from dust when the table is set in advance for dining before the guests enter.

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